

1917

RUSSIAN TSAR OVERTHROWN

Revolution broke out in Russia in February when protesters took to the streets of Petrograd demanding bread and peace. The Russian army, suffering dreadful losses in the war, supported the workers. Tsar Nicholas abdicated and the Mensheviks, a moderate workers party, set up a government. In October, the Bolsheviks, revolutionary Communists, stormed the Winter Palace and seized power. Under Vladimir Lenin, Russia became the Soviet Union, the world's first Communist state.

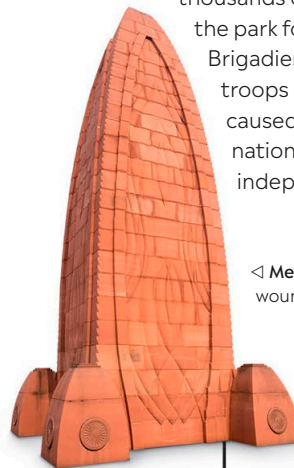


△ Soviet propaganda poster, 1917

1919

MASSACRE AT AMRITSAR

At least 379 unarmed Indians were killed by British-commanded troops at Jallianwala Bagh, a park in the holy city of Amritsar in the Punjab region. Worried by the rise of nationalism, British authorities had banned public meetings, but unaware of this, thousands of Punjabis had come to the park for a festival. Instructed by Brigadier General Dyer, British troops opened fire. The massacre caused outrage and stirred nationalists' demands for independence for India.



△ Memorial to the dead and wounded, Jallianwala Bagh, India

1917 The US enters World War I, declaring war on Germany and sending troops to France

1919 Benito Mussolini, an Italian journalist and politician, forms the National Fascist Party

1917 The British government declares support for a Jewish homeland in Palestine

1919 In the Red Summer, more than 30 race riots broke out in US cities in response to lynchings and segregationist laws

1919



△ Americans celebrate the armistice

1918

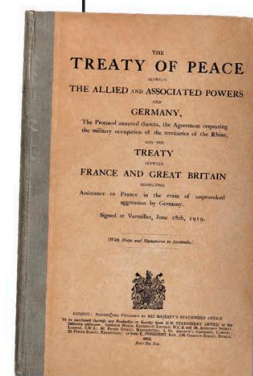
WORLD WAR I: ARMISTICE

At 11am on 11 November 1918, after more than four years of war and millions of casualties, guns across the world fell silent. By October, Bulgaria, Austria-Hungary, and Turkey had been defeated. Germany fought on but at home anti-war feeling was intense. The Kaiser abdicated, Germany admitted defeat, and on 11 November German and Allied delegations signed an armistice, or cease-fire, at Compiègne, France. News spread worldwide in minutes.

1919

PEACE TREATY ENDS WORLD WAR I

The war ended formally with the Versailles Treaty, which was signed on 28 June 1919 and came into effect in January 1920. The treaty was controversial. It was shaped by the "Big Four": Britain, France, Italy, and the US. Germany had to accept blame for the war and was forced to pay huge reparations to the Allies. All Germany's overseas colonies were taken over, and the German army was massively reduced.



△ Treaty of Versailles, front cover